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Interior Design Platform



Swagne

Stage 5 — Project Closure Report

Project : Swagne

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Raghad Naseef

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 **Live Demo**

 [**Visit Swagne**](#)



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Project Overview

Swagne is interior design marketplace that connects homeowners, interior designers, and service providers on a single platform.

The interior design industry lacks a unified digital space. Homeowners struggle to find trusted designers, designers manage scattered requests manually, and contractors receive unstructured briefs. Swagne solves this by giving each party a structured, tailored experience all working toward one goal: bringing the client's vision to life.

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Features

Feature	Client	Designer	Contractor
Browse designer profiles	✓		
Request a designer	✓		
Track project progress	✓		
Build design plans		✓	

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Features

Feature	Client	Designer	Contractor
Publish contractor offers		✓	
Receive & review offers			✓
Respond to offers			✓

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Tech Stack

Frontend	Backend	Dev Tools
React.js	Flask	GitHub
Figma	PostgreSQL	VS Code
GSAP	Python	Railway
	JWT	Thunder Client
	Stripe	Console & Network Tab

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Team



Khuloud alqarni

Backend Lead · UI/UX Designer ·
Frontend Developer



Layan Aldossari

QA Lead · Database Team · Frontend
Team



Banan Aleid

Database Lead · Backend
Developer · Frontend Team



Raghad Naseef

Frontend team

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Results



Goal	Backend
Three role-based user journeys (Client, Designer, Contractor)	✓
Designer profile browsing and request flow	✓
Design plan creation with 3-step stepper	✓
Contractor offer system	✓
Stripe payment integration	✓
JWT authentication with protected routes	✓
Full deployment on Railway (Frontend + Backend + DB)	✓
Responsive UI across devices	Landing Page only

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Key Metrics

- **3** user roles fully implemented
- **10+** core features delivered
- **3** deployment services running in production (Frontend, Backend, PostgreSQL)
- **1** integrated payment gateway (Stripe)
- **4** team members across frontend, backend, and QA

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Challenges & Lessons Learned



Challenge	Solution
JWT authentication returning 401 errors	Fixed via <code>@jwt.user_identity_loader</code> decorator
Python 3.14 incompatibility on a teammate's machine	Downgraded to Python 3.11.9 across all machines
Hardcoded localhost URLs breaking production	Migrated all URLs to <code>VITE_API_URL</code> environment variable
Role-based routing across three user types	Rebuilt <code>ProtectedRoute</code> with role-specific logic

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Technical Lessons



1. A successful server response doesn't mean the problem is solved always verify the full flow from
1. Storing tokens correctly (localStorage) is essential for maintaining user sessions across the app.
1. Any value that changes between environments should never be hardcoded — .env files keep the codebase flexible.
1. Authentication depends on the full integration between backend and frontend, not just one side.
1. The browser's console and Network tab are powerful debugging tools that saved us hours of guesswork.
1. Role-based routing must be defined early — knowing the user type from the start shapes the entire flow.

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Team & Process Lessons



1. Commitment matters. When every team member takes ownership, the whole product moves forward with less friction

1. Collaboration isn't just dividing tasks — it's supporting each other and sharing knowledge openly.

1. Any value that changes between environments should never be hardcoded — .env files keep the codebase flexible.

1. Learning never stops. Every bug taught us something no tutorial could..

1. A mistake is not failure. Some of our best decisions came directly from understanding why something went wrong.

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Retrospective



How We Worked as a Team

We coordinated our work through Git Project, tracking tasks, progress, and blockers in one shared space.

Roles were distributed based on personal interest and passion more than prior experience — which pushed each of us to grow beyond our comfort zone.

There were moments of imbalance in contribution, but we addressed them openly using commit history as objective evidence. That honesty made us a stronger team by the end.

Overall, our collaboration improved significantly as the project progressed

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Retrospective



What We Would Do Differently

- Assign responsibilities more clearly from Day 1
- Hold more frequent sync meetings during complex technical phases
- Document API contracts before building, not after
- Start deployment configuration in the first stage, not the last
- Never underestimate testing — treat it as a core part of development, not an afterthought
- Allocate dedicated time for testing and demo preparation earlier in the timeline

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Acknowledgements



This project would not have been possible without the people who walked this journey with us.

To our mentors at Holberton School and Tuwaiq Academy

Thank you for believing that learning is not a sprint. You taught us that knowledge is built slowly, with intention, and that the struggle is part of the process.

To everyone who tested Swagne and gave feedback

Your trust in the idea meant more than you know.

To our peers who stayed up late and debugged alongside us

This is as much yours as it is ours.

"Learning is a long road. It does not come in a rush. It comes through consistent effort, real

passion, and a genuine desire to grow — one line of code, one mistake, and one lesson at a time."